新可乐的 79 天

The 79 Days of New Coke



盲测胜出的新可乐，为什么遭到反对？

英文原文

Pepsi had set up **booths** in shopping centres across the US, inviting **shoppers** to **sip** two **unmarked beverages** and state a **preference**. Figures varied by region, but **tasters** generally picked Pepsi more often. Each stall, letting **consumers** judge by **palate** alone, doubled as **publicity**.

Coca-Cola's testing was **thorough** and **extensive**. Nearly 200,000 blind taste tests showed a sweeter **formula** beating the original and Pepsi. On 23 April 1985 the company announced it would replace its 99-year-old **syrup**, a year short of its **centenary**. The public called the **soda** New Coke. Its **sweetness** had given it a winning **flavour**, but launching the **concoction** was a **wager**.

The **backlash** was a **grassroots outcry**. Consumer **hotline** calls rose from about 400 a day to about 1,500, almost all **furious complaints**. **Protest groups** were **organised**, and some **faithful** drinkers **stocked up on** the original. In June 1985 one **protester**, Gay Mullins, filed a **lawsuit** to keep New Coke out of **packaging** like the original's. Its **dismissal** came a week later.

Pepsi's **chief executive** gave his **employees** a day off, treating the change as Coke's **concession**. After 79 days, on 11 July 1985, the original formula was **relaunched** as Coca-Cola Classic. The **U-turn** was a **vindication** for **loyalists**. ABC **interrupted** a soap opera to **broadcast** the **comeback**, which led two network **news bulletins**.

Coca-Cola had **misjudged** what the tests measured. They captured a **mouthful**, not the **emotional attachment** that nearly a century of **familiarity** had built. To many, the old taste carried **nostalgia** and **heritage**. The tests had hidden the brand from every taster, so they could not **quantify** what it meant to **fiercely loyal** drinkers.

中文译文

百事可乐曾在全美各地的购物中心设置了摊位，邀请购物者啜饮两种未标品牌的饮料，并说出自己的偏好。虽然数据会因为地区不同而出现差异，但品尝者总体上更常选百事。每个摊点让消费者仅凭味觉作出判断，同时也成了一种宣传。

可口可乐的测试既深入透彻，又覆盖面广。近20万次盲测显示，一种更甜的配方胜过原版可乐和百事可乐。1985年4月23日，公司宣布，将替换它那已有99年历史的糖浆，此时距百年只差一年。公众把这种汽水称为新可乐。它的甜味让它拥有了能（在盲测中）胜出的口味，但推出这款调制（饮）品是一场赌注。

这场反噬，是来自基层民众的强烈抗议。消费者热线来电从每天约400通激增到约1,500通，几乎全都是暴怒的投诉。抗议团体组织了起来，一些忠实的饮用者囤积了原版可乐。1985年6月，一位抗议者盖伊·马林斯提起了诉讼，要求禁止新可乐使用与原版相似的包装。这起诉讼被驳回，是在一周之后。

百事可乐首席执行官给他的员工放了一天假，把这次改变看作可口可乐的让步。79天后，1985年7月11日，原配方以可口可乐经典之名重新上市了。这种180度大反转，证明了这群忠诚拥护者是正确的。ABC 电视台中断了一部肥皂剧，播出可口可乐回归的消息，此事还领衔了两大电视网的新闻快报。

可口可乐误判了这些测试衡量的是什么。测试捕捉到的只是一小口的味道，而不是近一个世纪的熟悉所建立起来的情感依恋。对许多人来说，老味道承载着怀旧与传统。测试对每位品尝者都遮住了品牌，所以它们无法量化品牌对那些极其忠诚的饮用者意味着什么。

词汇与表达

booths n.
摊位

shoppers n.
购物者

sip v.
啜饮

unmarked adj.
未标品牌的
two unmarked beverages

beverages n.
饮料
unmarked beverages

preference n.
偏好
state a preference.

tasters n.
品尝者

consumers n.
消费者

palate n.
味觉
judge by palate alone

publicity n.
宣传
doubled as publicity.

thorough adj.
深入透彻
thorough and extensive.

extensive adj.
覆盖面广
thorough and extensive.

formula n.
配方
a sweeter formula

syrup n.
糖浆

centenary n.
百年

soda n.
汽水

sweetness n.
甜味

flavour n.
口味

concoction n.
调制（饮）品

wager n.
赌注
launching the concoction was a wager.

backlash n.
反噬
The backlash was a grassroots outcry.

grassroots adj.
来自基层民众的
a grassroots outcry.

outcry n.
强烈抗议
a grassroots outcry.

hotline n.
热线

furious adj.
暴怒的

complaints n.
投诉

Protest groups n.
抗议团体

organised v.
组织了

词汇与表达（续）

faithful adj.
忠实的
some faithful drinkers

stocked up on v.
囤积了
faithful drinkers stocked up on the original.

protester n.
抗议者
In June 1985 one protester, Gay Mullins, filed

lawsuit n.
诉讼
filed a lawsuit

packaging n.
包装
New Coke out of packaging like the original's.

dismissal n.
驳回
Its dismissal came a week later.

chief executive n.
首席执行官

employees n.
员工

concession n.
让步
Coke's concession.

relaunched v.
重新上市了
relaunched as Coca-Cola Classic.

U-turn n.
180度大反转

vindication n.
证明了……是正确的
a vindication for loyalists.

loyalists n.
忠诚拥护者

interrupted v.
中断了

broadcast v.
播出

comeback n.
回归

news bulletins n.
新闻快报

misjudged v.
误判了
misjudged what the tests measured.

mouthful n.
一小口

emotional adj.
情感

attachment n.
依恋
the emotional attachment

familiarity n.
熟悉

nostalgia n.
怀旧
nostalgia and heritage.

heritage n.
传统

quantify v.
量化
could not quantify what it meant

fiercely adv.
极其

loyal adj.
忠诚的

文章简述

- 盲测：百事让消费者不看品牌试饮，通常更受青睐。可口可乐做近20万次盲测，发现更甜的新配方胜过旧版和百事。
- 换方：1985年4月23日，可口可乐用新配方替换已有99年历史的老配方。百事把“改得更像百事”解读成认输，给员工放假一天庆祝。
- 反对：顾客投诉、囤积老款并组织抗议；有人起诉，要求新可乐别使用类似老版的包装，但案件被驳回。
- 回归：仅79天后，7月11日，老配方以“经典可口可乐”之名重售，回归消息成为电视新闻头条。
- 误判：盲测只问一口饮料哪个更好喝，不显示品牌，测不出顾客对老品牌、熟悉口味和往日生活的感情；试饮时选择新口味，不等于愿意放弃老可乐。